day, he hoped more shares would be taken.[101] After this meeting Somasundara Bharati went to Kakinada,[102] while his paid assistant Sarangapani Aiyangar left alone for Calcutta on a similar mission.[103] Enjoying the hospitality of the local zamindar of Pollavaram, Somasundara Bharati managed to sell 150 shares,[104] before proceeding to Bombay to raise capital there as well, with three other vakils from Tuticorin travelling to various other districts for the same purpose.[105]

V.A.A. Adinarayana Chettiar, a director, accompanied by a vakil, came to Erode in mid-May 1908 trying to sell shares. Meeting with no success they then proceeded to Karur. According to the district magistrate, a local pleader and the secretary of a local bank bluntly told them there was no hope of finding new shareholders.[106] But not all were as tight-fisted as the citizens of Erode. One V. Krishnaswamy Aiyar, brother of Madurai sub-judge V. Swaminatha Aiyar, contributed the considerable sum of Rs 2,000 to Kumaraswamy Reddiar of Tuticorin (possibly a director).[107] B.K. Ramaier went to Allepey, while Kumaraswamy Reddiar toured Salem and Palghat to canvass with C. Vijayaraghavachari.[108]

Evidently, all the major figures in the company, especially those who had backed VOC, spared no efforts to put the company on track again. Volunteers and agents too continued their efforts. *The Hindu* reported that the company was ‘vigorously selling shares in the districts’.[109]

The enthusiasm was not restricted to SSNCo’s directors. Venkatarama Aiyangar of Coimbatore, a high court lawyer, did not stop with subscribing to a hundred shares; he also rallied others to follow suit. At Madurai, two ‘enlightened Saurashtra leaders’, Tulsiram Ramachari and Venkatachalapathi Aiyangar, went from door to door urging members of their weaving community to subscribe. Their expectations were high, with hopes of raising at least 2,000 shares in the city. Lawyers such as Venkatarama Aiyar, Rama Aiyangar, Rangaswami Aiyar and Venkata Varada Aiyangar, *The Hindu* said, had ‘shown considerable practical sympathy by purchasing shares and debentures and doing canvassing work’.[110]